



AKC CGC Prep

CGC Skill 6 · Stay Builder Tracker



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Sit, Down, and Stay

Master cgc item 6.

Demonstrate sit and down on cue, then a stay while you walk 20 feet away. Your dog holds position until the evaluator releases them.

TRAINER NOTE

CGC prep is about reliable real-life manners — not perfection under pressure. Practice below threshold, log your reps,

Start here

Dog's name

Target test date

Handler name

Best reward

Know the criteria

Dog sits and downs on command.

Handler asks dog to stay, walks 20

feet away, and returns. Evaluator may use distraction.

1 Official skill criteria

Handler mechanics

One clear cue for sit and down — no repeating.

End on success

Stop while your dog can still think, eat, and cooperate.

CGC ITEM 6

Dog sits and downs on command. Handler asks dog to stay, walks 20 feet away, and returns. Evaluator may use distraction.

Dog must stay until released.

2 Handler checklist

☐ One clear cue for sit and down — no repeating.

☐ Return to your dog before releasing.

☐ Build 20-foot distance over multiple sessions.

☐ If your dog breaks, shorten distance — don't repeat stay cue.

Supplies needed

- 6-ft leash
- Front-clip harness
- High-value treats



CGC PRACTICE · FITDOG

3 Step-by-step practice plan

Practice sit and down in a new location — one cue each.

Build stay: 5 seconds at 5 feet, then 10 seconds at 10 feet.

Walk 20 feet away. Pause. Return to your dog's side before releasing.

Add mild distraction — person walking past at 15 feet.

Log longest successful stay at 20 feet this week.

4 Common reasons dogs fail this item

- ☐ Breaking stay before release
- ☐ Needing multiple cues
- ☐ Handler releasing from distance
- ☐ Dog creeping forward

5 Weekly practice log

Date	Setup	Duration	Success 1–5	Notes / next step
Day 1	Easy environment	5 min		
Day 2	Add one distraction	5 min		
Day 3	Hold difficulty	5 min		
Day 4	New location	5 min		
Day 5	Review + film	5 min		





TEST DAY · READINESS

6 Test-day readiness checklist

FITDOG TRAINER HOMEWORK

A CGC stay is built in layers — duration, distance, then distraction — never all three at once on day one.

- ☐ 20-ft stay at home
- ☐ Sit/down first cue in new location
- ☐ Release word practiced

7 Self-score before scheduling your evaluation

Question	Yes	Not yet
Dog succeeds 4/5 reps in practice this week		
Handler can explain criteria without reading notes		
Dog can eat treats in practice environment		
No safety concerns (bite risk, panic, escape)		
Ready to schedule official CGC evaluation		

REA Schedule evaluation — stack wins look solid

HOL Another 2 weeks of practice at this skill

HEL Contact Fitdog for trainer support

8 Notes for your trainer or evaluator

Observation	Details
Strongest rep this week	
Hardest moment	
Equipment that helped	
Question for test day	